

Chest-Pain Triage Protocol - Literature Review

Compiled by Nate Wright, PA-C for the Harborview chest-pain triage initiative. Working bibliography and summary, November 2026. For internal initiative use; clinical thresholds to be confirmed with Dr. Engstrom before publication.

Themes From The Evidence

- Early 12-lead EKG acquisition shortens door-to-decision time and is the most consistent lever in the literature.
- Validated risk scores improve safe discharge rates for low-risk chest pain when paired with troponin testing.
- High-sensitivity troponin pathways allow accelerated rule-out with structured serial sampling.
- Standardised order sets reduce inter-provider variation, the core problem this initiative targets.

Reference Notes (paraphrased, for internal use)

- Guideline statements on acute chest pain evaluation - emphasis on rapid EKG and risk stratification.
- Accelerated diagnostic pathway studies - safe reduction in length of stay for low-risk patients.
- High-sensitivity troponin rule-out protocols - sensitivity and timing trade-offs.
- Quality-improvement reports on order-set adoption in community EDs.

How This Shapes Our Draft

The protocol anchors on a firm time-to-EKG target, a single validated risk score, and a serial troponin rule-out. Each value used in the final deck must come from the locked draft, not an earlier version. Audit the protocol over a 90-day window after go-live in Q1 2027.